

Malhar Gudekar

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

August 2024 - May 2026

Master of Science, Information Management

GPA: 3.8/4

• Coursework: Web Programming, Machine Learning & Cloud, Information Management, Information Consulting, Methods of Data Science

University of Mumbai

June 2019 - May 2023

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science

GPA: 9.25/10

• Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Object-Oriented Programming, Machine Learning, NLP

SKILLS

• **Languages & DSA:** Python, SQL, Data Structures & Algorithms (Arrays, Hashing, Trees, Graphs, Dynamic Programming), LeetCode

• **Backend & Systems:** FastAPI, REST APIs, Microservices, Distributed Systems, ETL Pipelines, Kafka, PySpark

• **Databases, Cloud & Tools:** PostgreSQL, Neo4j, AWS (S3, EC2, EKS), GCP, Docker, Git

WORK EXPERIENCE

Business Intelligence Group

August 2025 - December 2025

Technical Consultant

Champaign, USA

- Built and deployed production RAG and agentic AI system in Python using FastAPI, PostgreSQL, and vector embeddings, implementing agentic workflows with tool use, prompt engineering, and iterative retrieval evaluation to improve output accuracy
- Designed fault-tolerant document ingestion pipelines implementing chunking strategies, embedding generation, and vector indexing to support low-latency RAG retrieval and reranking workflows
- Improved RAG retrieval efficiency by 64% through optimized indexing, reranking strategies, and iterative evaluation of retrieval quality and answer grounding in production
- Developed backend services enabling real-time, high-performance **AI model serving** of unstructured data across distributed systems

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

May 2025 - Present

Research Assistant - iSchool

Champaign, USA

- Owned **end-to-end design, development, and integration** of cross-platform **AI backend system** ingesting wearable data for 100+ users, enabling scalable data collection and downstream analytics
- Designed and optimized **PostgreSQL schema, indexing strategies, and distributed query execution plans** for high-volume datasets, improving query performance by 38% in production workloads
- Built robust, production-ready **Python generative AI pipeline** with retrieval and context summarization, improving response accuracy by **43%**
- Developed **asynchronous backend workflows** for real-time, fault-tolerant processing of longitudinal health data with focus on scalability

Research Assistant - CHI AI in Infodemic Management

January 2025 - May 2025

- Designed and deployed highly **scalable NLP and generative AI pipelines** in **Python** to process datasets, reducing processing latency by **41%**
- Built distributed ingestion and knowledge graph pipelines using Kafka and Neo4j, enabling graph-based entity linking, retrieval fusion, and real-time high-throughput processing for AI-powered search workflows
- Designed and developed **production-grade REST APIs using FastAPI** to serve AI models, implementing validation, monitoring, and automated deployment workflows to ensure **scalable integration** across distributed systems
- Enabled large-scale data processing across social media streams using **distributed systems and large-scale processing** principles

Swift Mobil Software Solutions Provider

July 2023 - October 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

- Built interactive **Power BI** dashboards for **logistics** and **mobility KPIs**, reducing reporting time by **40%** and improving operational visibility
- Processed and optimized large-scale datasets using **Python** and **PySpark** to identify failure and performance issues in distributed systems
- Developed **SQL** and **graph queries** to map dependencies, analyze operations, detect data issues, speeding root-cause analysis by **26%**

Pscope Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

January 2023 - June 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

- Developed and maintained **20+ Power BI** dashboards across Sales, Finance, and Operations for enterprise clients, leveraging **SQL** and **DAX**, enabling KPI tracking and data-driven decisions
- Automated recurring **Excel**-based workflows using **VBA**, implementing validation and scheduling logic, reducing report preparation time by **42%** and improving consistency

Stu/Dio at Illinois

August 2025 - Present

Project Manager

Champaign, USA

- Led cross-functional team of **6** engineers and designers to deliver **AI-driven product features** for DeepCover game, leveraging feedback and performance insights for feature prioritization
- Tracked **sprint** progress, delivery metrics, and **QA issues** through **JIRA**-based workflows, managing backlog and issue resolution

PROJECTS

Scalable ML System for Customer Risk Prediction

March 2025

UIUC Hackathon

- Built an **end-to-end machine learning system** using Python, Pandas, and LightGBM to forecast customer spending and assess credit risk from large-scale **time-series** transaction data, including data preprocessing, feature engineering, model training, and evaluation
- Designed and implemented **scalable ETL and feature engineering pipelines**, capturing behavioral trends and temporal patterns such as rolling averages and spending frequency to improve model performance
- Developed a **decision framework for credit line adjustments**, incorporating model outputs and risk thresholds to improve prediction precision by 20% and enable risk-aware classification of customers